Is your dog stressed?

Subtle signs of stress can be easy to miss, but they affect your dog's well-being. Use this checklist to identify possible stress and take action.

Physical signs

- [ ] Excessive panting (even when not hot or active)
- [ ] Pacing or trembling
- [ ] Frequent yawning or lip licking
- [ ] Fidgeting such as chewing the leash
- [ ] Sudden shedding
- [ ] Skin issues (allergic reactions, excessice dandruff)
- [ ] Digestive issues (diarrhea, vomiting, loss of appetite)
- [ ] Self-mutilation (licking, chewing, or scratching excessively)

Behavioral signs

- [ ] Avoiding eye contact or turning away, whale eye
- [ ] Freezing or 'shutting down' emotionally
- [ ] Excessive barking, whining, or howling
- [ ] Increased aggression or sudden reactivity
- [ ] Hiding or seeking excessive comfort from the owner
- [ ] Hyperactivity or inability to settle, restlessness

Instagram: @fluffy.breakers

Environmental triggers

- [ ] Overstimulation (too much socialization, noise, or activity)
- [ ] Sudden changes in routine or environment, no predictability
- [ ] Repetitive, forced, or high-intensity exercise
- [ ] Lack of a safe space to rest, no personal space
- [ ] Conflict with other pets or humans
- [ ] Being touched too much or too little

What to do next

If you checked more than 5 signs, your dog may be experiencing stress. Here's what you can do:

- [ ] Give your dog a calm and predictable routine
- [ ] At the same time, to build self-confidence, give your dog choices within set boundaries
- [ ] Let your dog be a dog - let them chew and sniff :)
- [ ] Reduce overwhelming situations and provide a quiet resting space - good quality sleep works wonders
- [ ] Offer mental enrichment (sniffing mats, puzzle toys, treat searching on the walks)
- [ ] Follow me and learn more about dogs and their behavior :)